

Important Characteristics of Structured Data

- ❑ Dimensionality
 - ❑ Curse of dimensionality
- ❑ Sparsity
 - ❑ Only presence counts
- ❑ Resolution
 - ❑ Patterns depend on the scale
- ❑ Distribution
 - ❑ Centrality and dispersion

Data Objects

- ❑ Data sets are made up of data objects
- ❑ A **data object** represents an entity
- ❑ Examples:
 - ❑ sales database: customers, store items, sales
 - ❑ medical database: patients, treatments
 - ❑ university database: students, professors, courses
- ❑ Also called *samples* , *examples*, *instances*, *data points*, *objects*, *tuples*
- ❑ Data objects are described by **attributes**
- ❑ Database rows → data objects; columns → attributes